

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Model validation and governance professional with ~7 years across pension ALM, investment risk analytics, and quantitative model development, applying for the Senior Director, Model Validation role at HOOPP. Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios at Moody's Analytics (\$5-25bn per engagement). Validates pricing, investment, and actuarial-liability models; reviews AI/ML-assisted analytical workflows. CFA and dual MSc (Financial Modelling; Engineering).

CORE SKILLS

Independent Model Validation & Review • Conceptual Soundness & Methodology Review • Model Risk Governance & Model Inventory • Valuation, Pricing & Investment Model Review • Actuarial Liability & Pension Modelling • Stochastic & Monte Carlo Scenario Modelling • AI/ML Workflow Review & Agentic Development • Python, SQL, MATLAB, R • Constructive Challenge & Stakeholder Influence

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director, Modelling Services | Toronto, May 2023 – Present

Independent Validation & Conceptual Soundness Review

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional client portfolios – \$5-25bn per engagement, ~\$50bn+ cumulative – independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Validate derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation; cross-check sensitivity consistency and implementation accuracy at portfolio-level investment and ALM aggregates.
- Evaluate conceptual soundness, methodological rigor, and economic defensibility of model outputs; escalate outputs that pass internal checks but fail economic-defensibility standards, serving as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues with Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.

Model Governance, Documentation & Performance Monitoring

- Operate within a formal model-governance framework – assumption validation, change-control review, documentation standards, and ongoing performance monitoring consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 model-risk-management expectations.
- Prepare model risk summaries for senior stakeholders covering interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities, translating quantitative outputs into committee-ready narratives.

Model Development & AI/ML-Assisted Validation Workflows

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios across investment and liability horizons, with embedded behavioral assumptions and macro stress overlays.
- Developed agentic AI workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) to automate first-pass validation scaffolding, anomaly detection, and documentation – human sign-off retained on all governance-critical review steps; estimated 30-40% reduction in development and review cycle time on comparable modules.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and reconciliation controls.

Client Service Specialist | Toronto, May 2022 – May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe analytics platform – advised on asset, liability, and ALM configurations; validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Acted as technical liaison between client investment teams and Product Owners, translating requirements into development requests and challenging configuration choices against model and data-quality expectations.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant, IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 – Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients – advised actuarial, finance, IT, and risk functions on adoption, governance documentation, and regulatory-readiness processes.
- Contributed subject-matter input to IFRS 17 product offerings and implementation collateral, coordinating across multidisciplinary teams on milestone delivery.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant, Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 – Sep 2021

- Built and validated stochastic economic scenario generators assessing interest-rate, inflation, and currency risk under base and stressed regimes for Canadian and international pension funds.
- Modelled pension actuarial liabilities alongside all major investment-product types and economic variables; conducted funding-ratio, duration-gap, and LDI analysis informing Strategic Asset Allocation recommendations.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR via Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition, attribution, and near-optimal frontier analysis to test the robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Led the ALM study and model build for a three-plan university pension merger (new jointly-sponsored plan) – on a team of three developing and validating the model capturing all Funding Policy dynamics, duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlays; presented findings to investment committees on-site.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) – CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling – Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) – Western University, 2016